

MODULE 7: PREPARING FOR FAMILY AND FUTURE RESPONSIBILITIES

Texts: Proverbs 22:6, Proverbs 24:27, 1 Timothy 5:8, Luke 14:28-30, Ephesians 5:22-33, Joshua 24:15

Introduction

Every young person desires a successful future. However, a successful family life and responsible adulthood do not happen by chance; they require preparation. God expects His children to prepare spiritually, mentally, emotionally, academically, financially, and morally for the responsibilities that come with adulthood, marriage, parenthood, leadership, and service.

Preparation today determines the quality of our future tomorrow. Many family and societal problems arise because people enter adulthood without adequate preparation.

Memory Verse

"Prepare thy work without, and make it fit for thyself in the field; and afterwards build thine house." — Proverbs 24:27 (KJV)

Meaning of Family and Future Responsibilities

Family Responsibilities

These are duties and obligations associated with family life, including:

- Being a responsible spouse
- Raising godly children
- Providing for family needs
- Maintaining peace and unity in the home
- Showing love, care, and support

Future Responsibilities

These include:

- Career and professional responsibilities
- Financial management
- Leadership roles
- Community service
- Spiritual responsibilities
- Nation-building responsibilities

Why Preparation is Necessary

1. God is a God of Planning

Before creation, God planned everything perfectly.

Scripture:

Luke 14:28-30

"For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost..."

Lesson:

Wise people plan before acting.

2. Preparation Prevents Future Failure

Many failures result from inadequate preparation.

Scripture:

Proverbs 21:5

"The thoughts of the diligent tend only to plenteousness..."

Lesson:

Diligence and preparation produce success.

3. Preparation Builds Confidence

When people prepare adequately, they face future challenges with confidence.

Scripture:

2 Timothy 1:7

"For God hath not given us the spirit of fear..."

Areas of Preparation for Family and Future Responsibilities

A. Spiritual Preparation

A strong future begins with a strong relationship with God.

Scripture:

Matthew 6:33

"But seek ye first the kingdom of God..."

Practical Steps

- Maintain daily devotion.
- Develop a prayer life.
- Study the Bible regularly.
- Participate actively in church activities.
- Build godly character.

Example

Joseph prepared spiritually through faithfulness to God and eventually became a leader in Egypt (Genesis 39-41).

B. Character Preparation

Character is more important than talent.

Scripture:

Proverbs 20:7

"The just man walketh in his integrity..."

Essential Character Traits

- Honesty
- Integrity
- Humility
- Patience
- Faithfulness
- Self-control

Example

Daniel maintained godly character even in a foreign land (Daniel 1:8).

C. Educational and Career Preparation

Education and skill acquisition help individuals become productive and responsible.

Scripture:

Proverbs 22:29

"Seest thou a man diligent in his business? he shall stand before kings..."

Practical Steps

- Take studies seriously.
- Learn vocational skills.
- Develop leadership abilities.
- Pursue excellence.

Discussion Question

How can laziness affect future family responsibilities?

D. Financial Preparation

One major responsibility in adulthood is financial stewardship.

Scripture:

1 Timothy 5:8

"But if any provide not for his own..."

Principles of Financial Preparation

1. Learn to save.
2. Avoid wasteful spending.
3. Develop productive habits.
4. Learn financial discipline.
5. Trust God while working diligently.

Example

Joseph stored food during years of abundance to prepare for famine (Genesis 41:33-36).

Lesson

Responsible financial management today prepares one for future family needs.

E. Emotional Preparation

Healthy relationships require emotional maturity.

Scripture:

Ecclesiastes 3:1

"To every thing there is a season..."

Signs of Emotional Maturity

- Ability to manage anger
- Respect for others
- Patience
- Forgiveness
- Effective communication

Discussion

Why is emotional maturity important in marriage and parenting?

F. Relationship Preparation

God intends families to be built on love, respect, and commitment.

Scripture:

Ephesians 5:25

"Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church..."

Scripture:

Ephesians 5:22

"Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord."

Important Lessons

- Respect God's design for marriage.
- Avoid immoral relationships.
- Develop healthy friendships.
- Learn communication skills.
- Maintain purity before marriage.

Scripture:

1 Corinthians 6:18

"Flee fornication..."

Responsibilities of Future Parents**1. Training Children****Scripture:**

Proverbs 22:6

"Train up a child in the way he should go..."

Parents are God's representatives in nurturing children.

2. Providing Guidance**Scripture:**

Deuteronomy 6:6-7

Parents are instructed to teach God's commands diligently to their children.

3. Providing Love and Care

Scripture:

Colossians 3:21

"Fathers, provoke not your children to anger..."

Responsibilities of Future Spouses**Responsibilities of Husbands**

- Love sacrificially.
- Provide leadership.
- Protect the family.
- Care for family needs.

Scripture:

Ephesians 5:25

Responsibilities of Wives

- Support family growth.
- Show respect.
- Build the home wisely.

Scripture:

Proverbs 14:1

"Every wise woman buildeth her house..."

Biblical Examples of People Who Prepared for Future Responsibilities**Joseph**

Scripture:

Genesis 41

Prepared Egypt for seven years of famine through wisdom and planning.

Lesson:

Preparation saves lives and preserves families.

David

Scripture:

1 Samuel 16-17

Prepared through years of shepherding before becoming king.

Lesson:

God often uses today's training for tomorrow's assignments.

Esther

Scripture:

Esther 4:14

Prepared herself spiritually and emotionally before fulfilling her destiny.

Lesson:

Preparation positions us for divine opportunities.

Consequences of Lack of Preparation

- Financial hardship
- Marital conflict
- Poor parenting
- Unfulfilled potential
- Spiritual weakness
- Poor decision-making

Scripture:

Hosea 4:6

"My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge..."

Practical Ways Young People Can Prepare Today

1. Develop a consistent prayer life.
2. Read and study God's Word.

3. Build godly friendships.
4. Focus on education and skill development.
5. Learn financial discipline.
6. Maintain sexual purity.
7. Respect parents and authority.
8. Serve faithfully in church.
9. Learn leadership skills.
10. Set godly life goals.

Conclusion

God desires every believer to become a responsible adult, spouse, parent, leader, and servant. Preparation is the bridge between today's opportunities and tomorrow's responsibilities. Those who prepare themselves spiritually, morally, academically, emotionally, and financially are better equipped to build strong families and fulfill God's purpose for their lives.

As Joshua declared:

"Choose you this day whom ye will serve... but as for me and my house, we will serve the Lord." — Joshua 24:15

May God help us to prepare wisely for our family and future responsibilities in Jesus' name. Amen.

Discussion Questions

1. Why is preparation important for future family life?
2. What role does spiritual growth play in preparing for adulthood?
3. How can young people prepare financially before marriage?
4. What character traits are essential for future family responsibilities?
5. What lessons can we learn from Joseph's preparation for Egypt's famine?

Assignment

Write five practical steps you will take this year to prepare for your future family and responsibilities, supported with relevant Bible verses.